

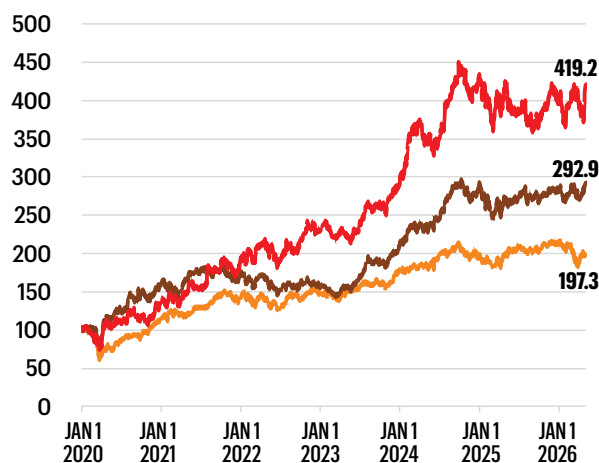
AT 70, DILIP SHANGHVI IS PLACING THE MOST CONSEQUENTIAL WAGER OF HIS 43-YEAR CAREER, AN \$11.75-BILLION ALL-CASH (INCLUDING DEBT) ACQUISITION OF ORGANON & CO.

IN A SINGLE STROKE, the deal takes Sun Pharma from being India's largest drugmaker to a top-tier global pharmaceutical company doubling its annual revenue to \$12 billion, increasing its presence to 150 countries, and giving it a 24,000-strong commercial sales force operating on the same field as Pfizer and AstraZeneca.

Whether it cements Shanghvi's legacy as the architect of India's first truly global pharma major, or whether, after four decades of disciplined wins, it finally tests the limits of his manual, will mould what comes next not just for Sun Pharma—where a new generation is ready to take on more—but also for the Indian pharmaceutical industry.

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UP AND UP



— NIFTY 50 — NIFTY PHARMA
— SUN PHARMACEUTICAL INDUSTRIES LIMITED

BASE INDEXED TO 100 SOURCE ACE EQUITY

"I'm happy, excited, also a little bit anxious. It is a large transaction that we are entering into," Shanghvi said at a press conference announcing the deal.

A man who has spent over four decades being almost pathologically cautious is now writing the largest cheque of his life, a contrast that traces back to a whole-sale medicine shop in the dust and din of Kolkata's bustling Dawa Bazar. It is also the first time he is stepping into businesses and geographies where Sun has limited prior operating experience.

With Organon, Shanghvi is taking Sun into a different league, competing not just with the world's largest generics manufacturers, but increasingly with multinational pharmaceutical companies that control innovation, brands and commercial reach.

"As a company, we always want to compete with players bigger than us," Shanghvi had told *Business Today* in an earlier interaction. "In each of the businesses we are present in, like generics, we have become a very big player because we continue to grow."

For a businessman who began with five psychiatry products and one salesman, the scale of the leap has been extraordinary.

FROM DAWA BAZAR TO BIG PHARMA

Shanghvi's father, Shantilal, ran a small medicine distributorship business in Kolkata, where the young Dilip, by his own account, would pore over drug labels and wonder how the molecules inside the bottles were made. For most boys growing up in such a setting, the predictable arc would have been to inherit the shop, marry well, and settle into the comfortable rhythms of the city's wholesale trade. Shanghvi chose a different path.

In the summer of 1983, the 28-year-old borrowed ₹10,000 from his father, packed up for Vapi in Gujarat,